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General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

First In The World

First In The World

MEN	WOMEN
• First man in space: Yuri Gagarin (Russia, 1961) • First man on the moon: Neil Armstrong (USA, 1969) • The first person to climb Mount Everest: Sir Edmund Hillary (New Zealand) and Tenzing Norgay (Nepal, 1953) • The first person to reach the South Pole: Roald Amundsen (Norway, 1911) • The first person to reach the North Pole: Robert Peary (USA, 1909) • The first person to sail around the world: Ferdinand Magellan (1519-1522) • The first person to fly an aeroplane: Orville Wright (USA, 1903) • The first man to cross the Atlantic by air: Charles Lindbergh (USA, 1927) • The first person to travel into space twice: Vladimir Titov (Russia, 1988) • First man to fly solo nonstop around the world: Steve Fossett (USA, 2005) • The first man to orbit the Earth: Yuri Gagarin (Russia, 1961) • First man to row solo across the Atlantic Ocean: John Fairfax (UK, 1969) • The first person to walk on all continents: George Meegan (UK, 1983) • The first person to complete a	• First woman in space: Valentina Tereshkova (Russia, 1963) • The first woman to climb Mount Everest: Junko Tabei (Japan, 1975) • The first woman to fly solo across the Atlantic: Amelia Earhart (USA, 1932) • First female Prime Minister in the world: Sirimavo Bandaranaike (Sri Lanka, 1960) • The first woman to win a Nobel Prize: Marie Curie (France, 1903 in Physics; later won in Chemistry, 1911) • The first woman to win an Olympic gold medal: Charlotte Cooper (UK, 1900, Tennis) • The first woman to win the Nobel Peace Prize: Bertha von Suttner (Austria, 1905) • First female pilot: Raymonde de Laroche (France, 1910) • First woman to win two Nobel Prizes: Marie Curie (Physics, 1903; Chemistry, 1911) • First female astronaut to go on a spacewalk: Svetlana Savitskaya (Russia, 1984) • First female CEO of a Fortune 500 company: Katherine Graham (USA, 1972, Washington Post) • First woman to become the U.S.

spacewalk: Alexei Leonov (Russia, 1965)	Secretary of State: Madeleine Albright (USA, 1997) • First woman to become a commercial airline captain: Emily Howell Warner (USA, 1973) • The first woman to complete the Boston Marathon: Kathrine Switzer (USA, 1967) • The first woman to win an Olympic medal in track and field: was Alice Milliat (France, 1921)

Science and Technology

- First artificial satellite: Sputnik 1 (Soviet Union, 1957)
- The first human-made object to reach outer space: the V-2 rocket (Germany, 1944)
- First successful heart transplant: Dr. Christiaan Barnard (South Africa, 1967)
- First cloned mammal: Dolly the sheep (Scotland, 1996)
- First test-tube baby: Louise Brown (UK, 1978)
- First digital computer: ENIAC (USA, 1946)
- First mobile phone call: Martin Cooper (USA, 1973)
- First e-mail sent: Ray Tomlinson (USA, 1971)
- First website: Tim Berners-Lee (CERN, 1991)
- First vaccine for polio: Jonas Salk (USA, 1955)
- First artificial heart implanted: Dr. Barney Clark (USA, 1982)
- First organ transplant (kidney): Dr. Joseph Murray (USA, 1954)
- The first person to cross the Atlantic by balloon: Ben Abruzzo, Maxie Anderson, Larry Newman (USA, 1978)
- First MRI scan on a human: Dr. Raymond Damadian (USA, 1977)
- First successful bone marrow transplant: Dr. Donnall Thomas (USA, 1956)
- First person to decode DNA structure: James Watson and Francis Crick (UK, 1953)
- First person to clone a gene: Herbert Boyer and Stanley Cohen (USA, 1973)

Sports

- First modern Olympic Games: Athens, Greece (1896)
- First FIFA World Cup: Uruguay (1930)
- First Cricket World Cup: West Indies (1975)
- First Grand Slam tennis title: Wimbledon (UK, 1877)
- First Formula 1 World Champion: Giuseppe Farina (Italy, 1950)
- First Tour de France winner: Maurice Garin (France, 1903)
- The first person to swim the English Channel: Matthew Webb (UK, 1875)
- First Paralympic Games: Rome, Italy (1960)
- First programmable computer: Konrad Zuse's Z3 (Germany, 1941)
- First video on YouTube: "Me at the Zoo" by Jawed Karim (USA, 2005)
- First electric car: Thomas Davenport (USA, 1834)
- First skyscraper: Home Insurance Building (USA, 1885)
- First supersonic flight: Chuck Yeager (USA, 1947)
- First solar-powered car: General Motors Sunmobile (USA, 1955)
- First transatlantic telegraph cable: Laid between Ireland and Newfoundland (USA, 1858)
- First website domain: Symbolics.com (USA, 1985)

Politics and Leaders

- First President of the United States: George Washington (USA, 1789)
- First President of the Soviet Union: Mikhail Gorbachev (Russia, 1990)
- First Prime Minister of India: Jawaharlal Nehru (India, 1947)
- First woman Prime Minister of the UK: Margaret Thatcher (UK, 1979)
- First Secretary-General of the United Nations: Trygve Lie (Norway, 1946)
- First African-American President of the USA: Barack Obama (USA, 2009)
- First Chancellor of Germany: Otto von Bismarck (Germany, 1871)

Authors and Literature

- First woman to win a Pulitzer Prize: Edith Wharton (USA, 1921, for The Age of Innocence)
- First English-language novel: Le Morte d'Arthur by Sir Thomas Malory (UK, 1485)
- First Nobel Prize in Literature: Sully Prudhomme (France, 1901)
- The first person to receive the Booker Prize: P.H. Newby (UK, 1969)
- First science fiction novel: Frankenstein by Mary Shelley (UK, 1818)
- First printed book (movable type): Gutenberg Bible (Germany, 1450s)

- First woman to win the Nobel Literature Prize: Selma Lagerlöf (Sweden, 1909)
- First female president of a country: Isabel Perón (Argentina, 1974)
- First African country to gain independence: Ghana (1957)
- First Asian country to hold elections: Japan (1890)
- First African-American woman to serve in U.S. Congress: Shirley Chisholm (USA, 1968)
- First woman to serve as the Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives: Nancy Pelosi (USA, 2007)
- First U.S. president to resign: Richard Nixon (USA, 1974)
- First democratically elected woman President of an African country: Ellen Johnson Sirleaf (Liberia, 2006)
- First transwoman to hold a national office: Georgina Beyer (New Zealand, 1999)

Technology & Innovation

- The first car was invented: by Karl Benz (Germany, 1885)
- First computer program: Ada Lovelace (UK, 1843)
- First electric light bulb: Thomas Edison (USA, 1879)
- First internet browser: WorldWideWeb (later Nexus, Tim Berners-Lee, 1990)
- First passenger railway: Stockton and Darlington Railway (UK, 1825)
- First 3D printer: Chuck Hull (USA, 1984)
- First camera phone: Kyocera VP-210 (Japan, 1999)
- First video game: Pong by Atari (USA, 1972)
- Ministers and Global Leaders
- First female Chancellor of Germany: Angela Merkel (Germany, 2005)
- First female U.S. Vice President: Kamala Harris (USA, 2021)
- First Indian woman President: Pratibha Patil (India, 2007)
- First Black woman to serve as U.S. Secretary of State: Condoleezza Rice (USA, 2005)
- First Indian to serve as Secretary-General of the UN: Vijayalakshmi Pandit (India, 1953)
- First woman Chief Justice of a country: Sandra Day O'Connor (USA, 1981)

Authors, Arts, and Literature - Additional Firsts

- The first woman to win a Booker Prize: Bernice Rubens (UK, 1970)
- First science fiction film: Le Voyage dans la Lune by Georges Méliès (France, 1902)
- First African-American to win a Pulitzer Prize: Gwendolyn Brooks (USA, 1950)

- The first movie to gross over $1 billion was was Titanic (USA, 1997)
- First comic book superhero: Superman (USA, 1938)
- First talkie film: The Jazz Singer (USA, 1927)
- First Nobel Prize awarded for economics: Ragnar Frisch and Jan Tinbergen (1969)
- First woman to win a Hugo Award for science fiction: Ursula K. Le Guin (USA, 1970)

Miscellaneous Firsts

- First newspaper: Relation aller Fürnemmen und gedenckwürdigen Historien (Germany, 1605)
- First artificial pacemaker: Rune Elmqvist (Sweden, 1958)
- First plastic surgery: Sushruta (India, 6th century BC)
- The first university in the world: University of al-Qarawiyyin (Morocco, 859 AD)
- First cloned animal: Dolly the Sheep (Scotland, 1996)
- First vaccine (smallpox): Edward Jenner (UK, 1796)
- First successful brain surgery: Dr. Harvey Cushing (USA, early 1900s)
- First human genome sequenced: Human Genome Project (International, 2003)
- First postage stamp: Penny Black (UK, 1840)
- The first human to perform a skydive: André-Jacques Garnerin (France, 1797)
- First human-made object to leave the solar system: Voyager 1 (USA, 1977)
- The first city to reach a population of 1 million: was Rome (Italy, 133 BC)
- The first person to break the sound barrier underwater: Dr. Robert Ballard (USA, 1966)
- The first country to legalize same-sex marriage: The Netherlands (2001)
- First paper currency: Tang Dynasty, China (7th century)
- First civil rights march for LGBTQ rights: Annual Reminders (USA, 1965)